

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's Reflections on: **PRAYER, PROCLAMATION and PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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IMPULSIVENESS – ACTING IMPULSIVELY

FOCUSING ON:

- ▶ **ACTING IMPULSIVELY** – Acting because without forethought
- ◆ Endeavoring to help God's people avoid acting in ways that can result in unhelpful things for them and affecting others.
- ◆ Also possibly helping people to identify some personal habits or characteristics of their lives that they might have not been aware of before and the need to make adjustments.
- ◆ To assist those who have not understood why we have those sudden impulsive urges and how they might be able to harness them so that they can act more decidedly.

Impulse means

- ◆ A sudden strong and unthoughtful urge or desire to act.
- ◆ Suddenly deciding to do something, without actually planning it.
- ◆ Impulse isn't something you've given a lot of thought to do because it was something that looked right and a good thing at the time, but it did not have a good ending.
- ◆ If you act on a sudden feeling or thought, **you're following an impulse.**

Questions

- ◆ Have we ever acted quickly – on impulse?
- ◆ Have we acted or made decisions without first giving proper thought to the results?
- ◆ Have we felt to act on impulse or inner urge and then later regretted it, because we realized we had acted too hastily?
- ◆ Acting without first giving prior thought as to what it might ultimately produce is not always wise.
- ◆ And then, there some people who act on impulse simply because they are unaware of what God's word states and are surprised when something unforeseen results.

Proverbs 22:3 A prudent person foresees danger and takes precautions. The simpleton goes blindly on and suffers the consequences. NLT (prudent = wise)

However

- ◆ There are times when we suddenly find ourselves in a crisis, OR facing an impending accident OR in danger of being injured or being killed **AND WE HAVE TO ACT ON IMPULSE** for the safety and preservation of our life or the lives of others, **AND THAT IS RIGHT THAT WE DO ACT in that way – praying for God to save/deliver.**

Biblical examples

1. PETER SAID: "I will never fall away" (be offended)

- ◆ But he spoke **impulsively** – because he was overconfident **and did not think whether** he had the ability to carry it out.

Matthew 26:31-34

31 Then Jesus said to them, "This night you will all fall away because of me, for it is written: 'I will strike the shepherd, and the sheep of the flock will be scattered.' - 32 But after I am raised, I will go ahead of you into Galilee."

33 Peter said to him, **"If they all fall away because of you, I will never fall away!"** - 34 Jesus said to him, "I tell you the truth, on this night, before the rooster crows, **you will deny me three times.**" NET

2. PETER SPEAKS impulsively and rebukes the Lord Jesus.

- ◆ How arrogant and disrespectful Peter was to speak like that to Jesus, even though **it was out of passion and love for Jesus**.
- ◆ However, **what he spoke** was completely against God's will for Jesus because it was planned that Jesus go to the Cross.
- ◆ **AND SO, Jesus rebukes Peter** for expressing what the Devil wanted instead of what God wanted.
Matthew 16:22 Peter took him aside and began to rebuke him. "Never, Lord!" he said. "This shall never happen to you!" NIV
Matthew 16:23 Jesus turned and said to Peter, "Get behind me, Satan! You are a stumbling block to me; you do not have in mind the things of God, but the things of men." NIV

3. PETER out of impulsiveness CUT OFF the priest's ear.

- ◆ **And Jesus had to rebuke Peter.**
John 18:10-11
10 Then Simon Peter drew a sword and slashed off the right ear of Malchus, the high priest's slave.
11 But Jesus said to Peter, "Put your sword back into its sheath. Shall I not drink from the cup of suffering the Father has given me?" NLT

4. PETER impulsively declares "I GO A FISHING". (back to the fishing business)

- ◆ Peter **assuming** that all was lost as far as his future as an apostle and preacher of the gospel was concerned – **acted impulsively** – and decided to go back to his old fishing business – which he had previously left behind him to follow Jesus.
John 21:3 Simon Peter saith unto them, I go a fishing. KJV
John 21:3 Simon Peter told them, "I am going fishing."

5. THE DISCIPLES OF Jesus also acted impulsively by deciding to follow Peter's impulsive action.

And all the other disciples; "We will go with you," they replied. NET

6. MOSES ACTED IMPULSIVELY when he killed the Egyptian.

- ◆ **He SUPPOSED** acted on a limited knowledge of what he thought he had authorization to do – but he didn't.
- ◆ Moses was aware that God was going to use him to deliver the Israelites from Egypt and so he **PRESUMED** that he had authorization to kill the Egyptian.; **and acted PRESUMPTIVELY.**
- ◆ In the heat of the moment in seeing one of his brethren (an Israelite) being physically abused by an Egyptian overseer **he acted IMPULSIVELY** and killed the Egyptian.
- ◆ **MOSES ACTED IMPULSIVELY BECAUSE HE FAILED TO ASK PERMISSION FROM GOD.**
- ◆ But in doing so it resulted in a disastrous outcome. His **premature action** miserably missed what God had planned for delivering Israel and Moses fled Egypt fearing for his life and spent the next 40 years in Exile.
Acts 7:24-25
24 And seeing one of them suffer wrong, he defended and avenged him who was oppressed, and struck down the Egyptian.
25 For he supposed that his brethren would have understood that God would deliver them by his hand, but they did not understand. NKJV

7. JOSHUA ALSO ACTED IMPULSIVELY WHEN HE TRUSTED HIS OWN INTUITION RATHER THAN ASKING GOD FOR HIS ADVICE OPINION ABOUT THESE MEN FROM GIBEAH

- ◆ He acted according to sight and what his eyes told him – **but he was deceived/ tricked.**
Joshua 9:14 The men examined some of their provisions, but they failed to ask the Lord's advice. NET
Joshua 9:14 So the Israelites examined their food, but they did not consult the Lord. NLT

8. WHEN ANY OF US FAIL TO ASK COUNSEL OF THE LORD, WE INCREASE THE RISK OF BEING DECEIVED OR TRICKED OR LED INTO THINKING THAT SOMETHING LOOKS REAL AND TRUE – BUT IS NOT.

▶ **IN ALL THY WAYS ACKNOWLEDGE**

Proverbs 3:6 in all your ways acknowledge him, and he will make your paths straight. NIV

▶ **DO NOT RELY ON YOUR OWN UNDERSTANDING**

Proverbs 3:5 Trust in the Lord with all your heart, and do not rely on your own understanding; Holman
Proverbs 3:5 lean not on your own understanding; NIV

▶ **ASK GOD FOR GUIDANCE**

Judges 20:18 And the children of Israel arose, and went up to the house of God, and asked counsel of God, and said, Which of us shall go up first to the battle against the children of Benjamin? And the Lord said, Judah shall go up first. KJV